

The Ones Who Stay

written by

William Kapadia

(864) 978-5651
william.d.kapadia@icloud.com

FADE IN:

1 EXT. STREET - NIGHT 1

Rain taps against pavement in a quiet neighborhood

Two houses sit close together, bedroom windows facing each other across a narrow gap

Thunder rolls in the distance

2 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT 2

Unpacked boxes everywhere

A cork board filled with recruiting letters

A football helmet sits on the desk, Star Wars and football posters line the walls

NOAH stands at his window and pulls the blinds halfway down

Across the gap between the houses he sees a light flip on

He stops pulling down the blinds

In the window he sees AVA roll to the window in her wheelchair, oxygen line on her face staring at the rain

She notices Noah, and they make eye contact

Noah gives a half-wave

Ava hesitates, then gives a small wave back

She closes her blinds slowly

Noah stands there a second longer before closing his blinds

Noah turns and walks to his bed to lay down

JULIA (O.S.)

Noah! Did you unpack your football gear? You've got practice tomorrow!

NOAH

Yes Ma'am!

3 INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - MORNING 3

Cloudy outside, Students walking through the halls

Noah is walking down the hall

EMMA sees him and goes over, twirling a strand of her hair

EMMA
(flirty)
Hey, Noah!

NOAH
Hi, Emma.

EMMA
What are you up to later?

NOAH
Football practice, why?

EMMA
Are you busy after? I thought we
could hang out

NOAH
Sorry, I can't

She drops her hair and puts her hand down

EMMA
Oh... okay, no problem

Noah goes to his locker and pulls out his phone

There are multiple unread messages from recruiters

He looks at a few, but doesn't respond

He locks his phone and puts it away

MASON walks up and shoves Noah lightly

MASON
Yo, Noah!

Noah turns around surprised and then sees it's Mason and daps
him up

NOAH
What's up, man?

MASON
(teasing)
Saw you talking to Emma

NOAH

Yeah, she won't give up... I'm just not interested. But I also don't want to make her feel bad or whatever. She's still my friend

MASON

Yeah, well you gotta do what you gotta do

The bell rings for class

NOAH

Alright, see you at practice

MASON

See you then

4 EXT. FOOTBALL PRACTICE - EVENING

4

Noah lines up at wide receiver

Mason lines up at corner, across from Noah

MASON

(confidently)

You're slow today

NOAH

You're delusional every day

Quarterback calls for the snap

Noah runs a post-corner route

Mason tries to jam him, but fails

The ball flies through the sky to Noah

He tracks it and catches it in stride

COACH REYNOLDS blows the whistle

COACH REYNOLDS

(loud)

Again!

Noah jogs to the quarterback and whispers with him

He jogs to the line and runs a post route

Noah loses Mason at his break with a double move

He tracks it again and catches it

Coach Reynolds blows the whistle

COACH REYNOLDS (CONT'D)
That's what I'm talking about!
Separation. You create space and
they can't touch you.

Noah nods

MASON
He only runs that clean because I
let him.

Noah shoves him lightly

NOAH
(confidently)
Scoreboard on Friday's gonna say
otherwise.

MONTAGE - NOAH AT PRACTICE

--Running routes

--Dropping a pass

--Staring at the field, distracted

END MONTAGE

Noah goes to get water, taking off his helmet

Coach Reynolds pulls him aside

COACH REYNOLDS
Recruiters called again.

Noah nods

COACH REYNOLDS (CONT'D)
You keep this up, you won't be here
long, kid.

Noah looks around the field

NOAH
Good.

COACH REYNOLDS
You love this game don't you?

NOAH

Yeah

COACH REYNOLDS

Good. The second you stop loving
it, it'll eat you alive.

Noah nods

Coach Reynolds turns around and blows the whistle

Noah jogs back to formation while putting his helmet back on

5 INT. LOCKER ROOM - EVENING

5

Noah is sitting quietly scrolling through his texts with
recruiters, not smiling

Everyone else on the team is joking around and hyped up from
practice

Mason notices Noah being quiet, and goes over to him

MASON

Noah

Noah doesn't look up, not paying attention

Mason waves in front of his face

MASON (CONT'D)

Noah

Noah looks up, blinking, trying to focus

NOAH

Yeah?

MASON

Bro, you just routed me up all
practice

NOAH

So?

MASON

So, you're sitting here looking
like we just lost the Super Bowl

NOAH

I'm just tired

MASON

Alright

Mason leaves

Noah opens a message from a recruiter

RECRUITER (TEXT)

You're exactly what we're looking
for from incoming freshmen

The noise around him gets loud again

He pulls out his AirPods and puts them in his ears

He plays the music loud

6 INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - EVENING

6

Noah is walking through the hall, tired from practice

There's a smaller kid, COLE, head down, hands in his pockets.

TRAVIS comes up to Cole in the hall

TRAVIS

Hey princess. You ever gonna say
anything? Or just stand there.

Cole doesn't respond, keeps walking

TRAVIS (CONT'D)

Hey, I'm talking to you.

Noah sees, Cole doesn't respond, but looks uncomfortable

TRAVIS (CONT'D)

What, you only talk when your
boyfriend's around?

Cole still doesn't respond, but still looks uncomfortable

Noah hesitates, but walks over to Travis and Cole

NOAH

Travis, what's your problem?

TRAVIS

No problem, Noah

NOAH

Then quit acting like it

TRAVIS

Whatever.

Travis walks off

TRAVIS (CONT'D)

(under his breath)

Not worth it anyway

Noah turns to Cole

NOAH

Hey, what's your name?

COLE

Cole

NOAH

I'm Noah...

(pause)

You don't have to just stand there
and let him talk to you like that

COLE

Thanks

Cole walks off still keeping his head down

Noah watches him walk away before turning to leave

7

EXT. OUTSIDE SCHOOL - EVENING

7

Cole is sitting alone on the curb staring at nothing

Noah walks out of the school and sees him

He hesitates, then walks over to him

NOAH

You good?

COLE

Yeah.

NOAH

You should come to the game Friday.

Cole looks up, surprised

COLE

Why?

NOAH
It'll be fun

Noah starts walking away, but turns back once

NOAH (CONT'D)
Not everyone's a jerk like Travis

Noah keeps walking

Cole watches him leave

8 INT. NOAH'S KITCHEN - NIGHT

8

Julia, Noah, and DAVID are at the table eating lasagna

DAVID
Noah, Coach Reynolds called earlier
(pause)
He said you'd easily be able to get
a scholarship at a lot of the big
football schools

NOAH
That's good

JULIA
Just good?

NOAH
It's great

JULIA
You seem... off

NOAH
I'm just tired... from the move.

DAVID
Son, you know I tore my ACL in my
sophomore year of college

NOAH
Yeah, I know

JULIA
(quietly)
David

DAVID
I'm not reminding you to scare you
or anything... But you have this
opportunity and you're just saying
it's "good". Don't waste this.

Noah nods slightly

NOAH

I know

They finish eating and Noah takes his plate to the sink

He puts it in the sink and looks out the window

He goes up to his room

9

INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

9

Noah lays in bed and looks at his phone

The time reads "8:29PM"

He waits a few seconds and it flips to "8:30PM"

He looks to the window

Through the gap, Ava's bedroom light flips on

He looks for a few seconds before she closes the blinds

He opens his phone and starts watching film

He falls asleep after watching three plays

The phone falls to his chest as he sleeps

10

EXT. FOOTBALL PRACTICE - MORNING

10

Noah walks onto the field sipping a protein shake and puts on his gear

Mason walks toward Noah

MASON

Hey man!

NOAH

Morning

MASON

Ready for the game this Friday?

NOAH

Hell yeah, we got this

Coach Reynolds blows the whistle

Everyone takes a lap and starts practice

11 EXT. FOOTBALL PRACTICE - MORNING

11

Noah sees Travis sitting on the bleachers with a few friends, laughing

As that group disperses, Noah goes over to Travis

TRAVIS
What's up?

NOAH
What was that yesterday?

Travis shrugs casually

TRAVIS
Nothing

NOAH
Didn't look like nothing

TRAVIS
He's just weird, man

NOAH
So?

TRAVIS
I was just messing around, it's not that deep

NOAH
Didn't look like he thought it was funny

Travis rolls his eyes

TRAVIS
Why do you care anyway?

NOAH
I don't know
(pause)
It just seemed unnecessary

Travis rolls his eyes

NOAH (CONT'D)
Just stop it.

Noah turns and walks away

12

INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

12

Noah laying on his bed throwing a football to himself

Clock shows "8:29PM"

Noah glances at the clock before it flips to "8:30PM"

Noah glances at the window, and across the gap the light flips on

Ava rolls her wheelchair to the window

She holds up a paper to the window:

"U just gonna stare every night?"

Noah reaches over to his desk to get a notebook and pen

He writes and holds up the notebook:

"Depends. U contagious?"

Ava reads it and gasps in mock offense

She writes again and holds up:

"Only emotionally"

Noah laughs slightly, then writes and holds up:

"Why are you always inside?"

Ava takes a deep breath before writing again

She holds up:

"Doctor's orders"

Noah's eyes drift to her oxygen line while she's writing

Ava holds up:

"What's ur excuse?"

Noah writes and holds up:

"Just moved here"

Ava nods

She writes again and holds up:

"Welcome to the most boring street in America"

Noah writes back:

"It has potential"

There's a pause

He writes:

"I'm Noah btw"

Ava pauses and writes:

"I'm Ava"

He writes:

"Nice name. What kind of stuff do you like to do?"

Ava writes and holds up:

"I used to dance"

Noah pauses for a second

He writes:

"What kind?"

Ava writes:

"Ballet"

Noah stares at her for a second, down to her wheelchair, then back up

He writes:

"Like... Serious ballet?"

Ava rolls her eyes dramatically

Then writes:

"Yes. Tutus and drama"

Noah laughs at her response then writes:

"Ok but were u good?"

Ava squints at him

She writes:

"Do a spin"

Noah puts his paper down and does a spin awkwardly, almost falling

She laughs and writes:

"I was better than you"

Noah sits back down

He writes back:

"I've never danced"

Ava writes:

"That's obvious"

Noah laughs at her response

Then he writes:

"So what happened?"

Ava looks down at her hands which are slightly trembling, and adjusts the oxygen tubing

She writes:

"My lungs decided pliés were optional"

Noah doesn't smile, but nods

Then he writes:

"Do u miss it?"

Ava doesn't answer right away

Rain taps against the window

She holds up:

"I miss not thinking about breathing"

Noah writes back slowly:

"I trip over air"

Ava looks confused so Noah writes:

"So I think ur still winning"

Ava laughs at that

Her hands tremble slightly

She adjusts oxygen tubing

On her nightstand: medication bottles, hospital bracelet, and
a transplant list document

Her breathing is slightly labored

She looks out the window

Noah is still there in the other room, watching

13

INT. NOAH'S KITCHEN - MORNING

13

Julia is over the stove making breakfast

Noah comes down looking happier than he usually does

JULIA

Morning, Noah

(pause)

You look excited, is something
happening?

NOAH

No, Mom. Nothing's happening

JULIA

You sure?

NOAH

Yes, I'm sure. I was just...
talking to someone.

JULIA

Someone? A girl?

NOAH

Maybe

JULIA

What's her name?

NOAH

Ava

JULIA

That's nice

She walks from the stove with eggs and toast on a plate and
hands it to him

JULIA (CONT'D)
Eat. Then school.

Noah starts eating

14 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - MORNING

14

Ava's sitting alone on her bed

She looks out the window and sees Noah leaving for school

She transfers slowly to her wheelchair

Rolls across the room and tries to stand up

She falls back into her wheelchair quickly

AVA
This is so stupid

She looks at her old ballet shoes on the shelf

She picks one up and throws it across the room

She holds her face in her hands and starts crying quietly

She rolls over to where the shoe landed and picks it up

She rolls back to the shelf and puts it back

There's a soft knock on her door

Ava wipes her tears and speaks shakily

AVA (CONT'D)
Come in

Claire walks into the room and can immediately tell Ava's been crying

She goes to Ava and hugs her

CLAIRE
What's wrong, Ava?

Ava clings to her, still in the wheelchair

AVA
I just feel so... Stuck
(pause)
I just want it to be over. I hate
this

CLAIRE
It'll be alright, honey. It'll get
better. I'm sure it'll be over soon

AVA
Promise

CLAIRE
I want to

Claire pulls back slightly and puts both hands on Ava's face

Claire pulls Ava back into the hug, tighter now

CLAIRE (CONT'D)
You're strong. You'll get through
this

AVA
I want to believe that... But it's
hard to when I can't even stand on
my own

CLAIRE
I know, but it's okay

Ava glances at Noah's bedroom window to see his empty room

Claire notices her glance but pretends not to

CLAIRE (CONT'D)
Ready to go downstairs and start
school?

AVA
I guess

Claire helps Ava out of her room and down the steps in the
wheelchair

15 INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

15

Noah is standing with Mason by their lockers

MASON
You okay, man? You look... off

NOAH
I'm good. It's just... There's this
girl... She lives next door to me.

MASON
 (teasingly)
 Oh no. Emma's gonna be jealous
 (pause)
 Don't get too distracted.

NOAH
 I won't

MASON
 Okay bro, tell me about her.

NOAH
 She's like, really pretty. She has
 some kind of lung disease. I think
 I like her.

MASON
 Like, like-like her?

NOAH
 I mean, we only talked once... But
 yeah

Noah and Mason don't notice another kid, Cole, listening from
 a distance

16 INT. AVA'S LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

16

Ava's doing school from her laptop
 She looks distracted

CLAIRE
 Ava, are you okay?

AVA
 Yeah, I'm good

CLAIRE
 What are you thinking about?

AVA
 Something

CLAIRE
 (knowingly)
 Something? Or Someone?

AVA
 (slightly embarrassed)
 Someone.

CLAIRE
Does this someone happen to be... a
boy?

AVA
Yeah

CLAIRE
Maybe... the boy next door?

AVA
How'd you know there's a boy next
door?

CLAIRE
Just a hunch
(pause)
Plus I saw you glance over at that
window earlier

Ava rolls her eyes playfully

AVA
Let me focus

She tries to focus back on her work

17 INT. SCHOOL CAFETERIA - AFTERNOON

17

Noah, Mason, Emma, NICK, and JESS are all eating and sitting
together

Travis and KENZIE are at another table with their friends

MASON
(teasingly)
Did you all hear Noah's got a
girlfriend?

Emma tenses at that

NOAH
(defensively)
She's not my girlfriend, and we
talked once!

MASON
Yeah, but you said you like her

Emma sits there quietly

Travis glances over from his table

NOAH
Can we talk about something else
now?

EMMA
Great idea! Let's talk about...
your football game this Friday?
(pause)
You know... something that actually
matters right now.

Noah glances at her with annoyance, but tries to hide it
Nobody else notices his glance

MASON
Yeah! Last time we played that team
we put BTA

JESS
I saw that game, it was good

NICK
Yeah, you guys did great on D,
didn't you get a pick that game?

MASON
Yeah, I did. It was great man

The voices fade around Noah as his mind drifts back to Ava

18 INT. DANCE RECITAL STAGE - NIGHT

18

Noah sitting in the audience

Ava on stage in her ballet outfit dancing perfectly

Noah smiles

19 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

19

MONTAGE - AVA AND NOAH WINDOW ROUTINE:

--Clock at 8:30 each night

--Papers pressed against windows

--Writing responses

--Mirroring each other's movements unintentionally

--Ava coughing, but acting okay

--Rainy nights, clear nights, windy nights

END MONTAGE

Ava holds up a sign:

"Favorite movie?"

Noah writes something

20

INTERCUT - NOAH'S BEDROOM / AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

20

Noah holds up:

"Star Wars"

Ava gasps in mock offense, writes and shows:

"Wrong. LOTR is superior storytelling"

Noah holds up back:

"Hell no, star wars is way better"

Ava starts writing something

Ava holds up:

"What do you think of Harry Potter?"

Noah thinks for a second and then writes:

"Never seen it"

He holds it up

Ava's jaw drops then she writes aggressively and holds up:

"That's illegal"

Noah laughs

He writes:

"Then arrest me"

Ava writes back while laughing:

"I would if I could chase you"

Noah writes back:

"Good thing I would try that hard to run from you"

Ava smiles

CLAIRE (O.S.)
(yelling from downstairs)
Ava! Come here, baby!

Ava waves

Closes her blinds and wheels away from the window

Noah writes another note

Noah leaves the note on the window

21 INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

21

Noah's alone by his locker

Travis and Kenzie talking across the hall

TRAVIS
Did you hear about Noah's new
"friend"?

He uses air quotes around the word

KENZIE
You mean the sick girl?

Emma walks over and joins the conversation

EMMA
He's going to get his heart broken
and lose his scholarship, and for
what? She can't even leave her
room.

Emma turns to face Noah a bit and tucks a strand of hair
behind her ear

Noah tries to ignore their conversation, but it escalates

TRAVIS
And he shouldn't be wasting her
time either. She'll be dead soon
enough. She's not getting better.

Noah turns slightly, unable to hold back anymore

He walks over to Travis

NOAH
What did you just say?

TRAVIS
You heard me

NOAH
Say it again.

Emma touches Noah's arm

EMMA
Noah. Stop, it's not worth it

Noah shrugs her hand off of him

NOAH
(ignoring her)
Say it.

TRAVIS
I said why waste your time on her,
when she's already dying anyway?
She's not gonna get better.

NOAH
You're not gonna talk about her
like that.

TRAVIS
Or what?

Travis shoves Noah slightly

Noah shoves Travis against the locker

Hits him in the face

Blood trickles down Travis' nose

Some teachers come to break up the fight

22

INT. PRINCIPAL'S OFFICE - AFTERNOON

22

Noah and Travis both sit in the office across from PRINCIPAL
WILLIAMS

PRINCIPAL WILLIAMS
Alright, Travis... Detention. Noah,
you're suspended for a week.
(pause)
Head back to class

Travis gets up and leaves

Noah stays behind a few seconds longer

PRINCIPAL WILLIAMS (CONT'D)
You want to explain yourself?

NOAH
I don't have an excuse. But he was
talking shit about my friend.

PRINCIPAL WILLIAMS
What did he say?

NOAH
He called her "the sick girl"

PRINCIPAL WILLIAMS
That doesn't justify starting a
fight.

NOAH
I know.

PRINCIPAL WILLIAMS
Go home.

Noah gets up and leaves

23

INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

23

Emma's waiting outside the principal's office

Noah walks out, past Emma

Emma catches up to him and walks beside him

EMMA
What the hell was that?

NOAH
Nothing. Just leave it alone

EMMA
No, I'm not going to leave it
alone, Noah. You're throwing
everything away over a girl you
just met!

NOAH
I'm not.

EMMA
Yeah, you kinda are. But you can't
even see it...

NOAH
Emma. Drop it.

EMMA
Fine. But you're making a mistake.

Noah doesn't respond this time, he just walks away from Emma

24

EXT. STREET - AFTERNOON

24

Noah arrives at his house and Julia comes outside

JULIA
Noah? Why are you home already?

NOAH
I got suspended

JULIA
For what?

NOAH
I got into a fight

JULIA
You got into a fight?!

She immediately starts checking him for injuries

NOAH
Yeah, I'm fine

JULIA
What happened?

NOAH
I punched Travis

JULIA
(sternly)
Why?

NOAH
He was talking about Ava

JULIA
Ava? The girl next door?

She gestures toward Ava's house

NOAH
Yeah

JULIA
Was she there?

NOAH
No, she doesn't go to school

JULIA
What? Why not?

NOAH
She's got a lung disease... She
can't go out

JULIA
Oh... What did they say about her?

NOAH
They called her "The sick girl" and
said "She'll be dead soon enough"

JULIA
You could've stood up for her
without punching him.

NOAH
I know

He goes inside

25 INT. NOAH'S KITCHEN - EVENING

25

David walks in after talking to Julia

DAVID
Son, your mom told me what happened
at school

NOAH
Okay

DAVID
Why would you start a fight over
something stupid like that? It's
not worth getting suspended.

NOAH
I think it was

DAVID
You think it was worth it? You're
being reckless. You're going to
ruin your future. You have to
control yourself

NOAH

I was controlling myself. I knew what I was doing.

DAVID

Then why the hell did you do it?

NOAH

You know what they said

DAVID

Yes, I know what they said. That's not more important than football. You have a serious future in football, son. You can't throw it away because of a stupid fight because you couldn't control yourself.

NOAH

I just told you. I was controlling myself. I made that choice.

DAVID

Go to your room.

Noah goes up to his room

26

INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - EVENING

26

Noah's sitting on his bed scrolling on his phone

It rings with a call from Coach Reynolds

He waits a second before answering

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)

I heard what happened

NOAH

Yeah

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)

Why would you do that?

NOAH

He was being a jackass

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)

That's not a reason to punch him. You have to think about the team too. We needed you on Friday.

(pause)

(MORE)

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 After practice Monday, you owe me
 50 up-downs, 40 pushups, 4 laps,
 and 40 yards of suicides.

NOAH
 Yes sir

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
 Don't do that shit anymore

NOAH
 Yes sir

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
 And study film.

Coach Reynolds hangs up

Noah puts his hand on the drawer of his nightstand and holds
 it there for a second

He pulls it back and opens his phone to watch film

DISSOLVE TO:

27

INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

27

Noah's laying in bed still watching film

He takes notes on his mistake

NOAH
 (to himself)
 I didn't break down fast enough

The clock flips to "8:27PM"

His phone is on the nightstand

It starts ringing

Noah picks up the phone and it shows an unknown number

He hesitantly answers it, and puts the phone to his ear

AVA (V.O.)
 You're actually proud of not
 watching Harry Potter?!

Noah immediately smiles and goes to the window

Ava's at her window and waves

NOAH
You got my number from the sign.

AVA (V.O.)
You left it

NOAH
You stalking me now?

AVA (V.O.)
Please. I can't even walk to my
mailbox and back

He listens and can hear the strained breathing, doesn't react

NOAH
Okay. So sell me on it.

AVA (V.O.)
On what?

NOAH
Why should I watch it?

Ava thinks for a second

AVA (V.O.)
Because it's about people who stay.

Ava pauses for a few seconds

AVA
Anyway... I saw you got home from
school early today

NOAH
Yeah

AVA (V.O.)
Why?

NOAH
I got suspended

AVA (V.O.)
Why? What did you do?

NOAH
Got into a fight.

She rolls her eyes playfully

AVA (V.O.)
Noah.

28 INT. RESTAURANT - EVENING

28

Noah, Mason, Emma, Jess, and Nick are all eating dinner

EMMA
You've been pretty quiet lately,
you okay?

NOAH
Just tired

EMMA
Okay, you sure?

NOAH
Yeah, I'm sure

EMMA
Alright, eat your burger... You
barely touched it

NOAH
I'm not hungry

Noah looks at his phone and sees the time: "8:15PM"

Noah stands up

EMMA
Where are you going?

NICK
You leaving already?

NOAH
Yeah, I gotta get home

JESS
Home? You usually stay out
until like 9

EMMA
(under her breath)
Of course you do.

NOAH
Yeah, I know. I can't tonight
though

MASON
Alright then. See you tomorrow

Noah waves and leaves

29 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - EVENING

29

Noah walks into his bedroom and turns the light on right as
the clock hits "8:29PM"

He sits on his bed looking across the gap through the window,
it's getting dark outside

Ava's bedroom light flips on and she rolls into view, already
with her phone to her ear

Noah's phone starts ringing with Ava's name

He answers it quickly and sits at the window

AVA

Hi, Noah

NOAH

Hey

AVA

So... you're like out a lot, right?

NOAH

Yeah, why?

AVA

Can you just, like... Tell me what
it's like to be able to be outside
nowadays?

NOAH

Yeah... You never go out?

AVA

(one shallow breath)
I mean... Sometimes.

30

INTERCUT - NOAH'S BEDROOM / AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

30

AVA

Hospitals count right?

NOAH

You hate that question, don't you?

AVA

I hate the face people make after
they ask it.

NOAH

What face?

AVA

The face where they're already
leaving.

NOAH
I'm not leaving.

She takes her time answering

AVA
You just got here.

NOAH
Yeah... Still.

Silence for 3 seconds, Both of them looking at each other

AVA
But, now can you tell me what it's like?

NOAH
Being outside? It's amazing, you were able to go outside before... right?

AVA
Yeah, but that was a long time ago

DISSOLVE TO:

31 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

31

Later that night, they're still on the phone

Her room is dim now, just the bedside lamp is on

She's in bed now, propped up by pillows with oxygen cannula on her cheeks

The phone is between her shoulder and ear

NOAH (V.O.)
What is it?

AVA
The disease?

NOAH (V.O.)
Yeah.

AVA
It's called Cystic Fibrosis. I was born with it, but it wasn't this bad until I was 9. That's when It got really bad and I stopped dancing... and actually having fun.

NOAH (V.O.)
 So you've been stuck inside for 8
 whole years?

AVA
 Pretty much

NOAH (V.O.)
 I'm sorry

There's a long silence

AVA
 You ever feel like you're stuck in
 the wrong body?

NOAH (V.O.)
 Like... What do you mean?

Ava stares at the ceiling

AVA
 Like your brain wants to run, or
 scream, or do something stupid.
 Sneak out, climb something, break
 something. But your lungs are like
 (pause)
 Nope

She tries to laugh, but it turns to a cough

She mutes the phone

32

INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

32

Noah waits it out silently, sitting on the floor

Ava unmutes herself

AVA (V.O.)
 Sorry.

NOAH
 Don't apologize for coughing. You
 alright?

AVA (V.O.)
 Yeah. I'm good

Noah stares at his corkboard with college recruiting letters

NOAH
When I'm running routes, It feels
like that's the only time I'm not
thinking.

AVA (V.O.)
About what?

He hesitates and picks at a thread on his carpet

NOAH
Expectations.

AVA (V.O.)
(serious tone)
Must be hard... Being wanted.

NOAH
(laughs slightly)
Alright, now you're just trying to
make me feel bad.

AVA (V.O.)
No

33 INTERCUT - NOAH'S BEDROOM / AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

33

She rolls onto her side to look at the rain on the window

AVA
I just mean, People see you and
they see potential.
(pause)
They look at me like I'm temporary

NOAH
That's not-

He stops himself from arguing

She cuts him off

AVA
It's fine. I'm used to it. Doctors
don't talk to me, they talk around
me, about me. Like I'm already a
memory.

NOAH
When recruiters call, they don't
ask me what I want either. They
just ask my forty time.
(MORE)

NOAH (CONT'D)
My weight, Vertical. Not if I'm
tired, or scared

AVA
Are you?

NOAH
Yeah... sometimes

Ava coughs again

AVA
Of what?

There's a long pause while Noah thinks

NOAH
What if I peak at seventeen? What
if this is the best I ever am? What
if I'm only valuable when I'm fast?
(pause)
But this sounds childish and stupid
compared to your issues

AVA
It's not
(pause)
You know what I'm scared of?

NOAH
What?

AVA
I'm scared that if I get better, I
won't know who I am without being
sick.

Noah blinks, Not expecting that answer

NOAH
You'd be... You.

Ava gives a tiny smile

AVA
Easy for you to say. You've always
had options.

NOAH
You have options.

AVA
Name one.

Noah opens his mouth, but doesn't speak and closes it because she's not wrong

Rain starts falling harder against the window

NOAH

Maybe you're not stuck in the wrong body. Maybe your body's just slower than you

AVA

That was dangerously poetic for a football player.

NOAH

Don't tell anyone. I have a reputation to maintain.

AVA

Noah?

NOAH

Yeah?

AVA

If I ever get to run with you for real, Promise you won't slow down for me.

NOAH

I wouldn't dare.
(pause. Softer now)
But I'd stay with you.

She closes her eyes and breathes slowly

AVA

Okay.

Rain continues falling outside

34

EXT. FOOTBALL FIELD - NIGHT

34

It's Friday Night

Stadium lights bright on the dark field, Crowd yelling

Noah lines up at Wide Receiver

Quarterback calls for the motion, then the snap

Noah runs

Silence except for his breathing
 The ball flies through the air to him
 He drops the pass

COACH REYNOLDS
 Noah! Lock the hell in, son!

He lines up again
 Quarterback calls for the motion, then snap again
 This time, he catches the pass
 The crowd erupts in cheers as he scores the touchdown

35 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT 35

Ava's wrapped in a blanket on her bed streaming the game on her laptop
 She smiles and coughs but keeps smiling

36 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT 36

Later that night
 Noah is still sweaty from the game
 Phone to his ear at the window

NOAH
 You watched?

AVA (V.O.)
 You allowed an interception in the second quarter.

NOAH
 You don't even know what an interception is.

AVA (V.O.)
 I Googled it, asshole.

Noah laughs softly
 A second call comes in on Noah's phone, from a recruiter

NOAH
Hey, Ava. Give me a few minutes,
okay? A recruiter's calling.

AVA (V.O.)
Okay, I'll wait right here.

INTERCUT:

37 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

37

Ava looks over to the window and sees Noah on the phone
talking to the recruiter

After the short call her phone rings with Noah's name on the
screen, she answers

AVA
What'd they say?

NOAH (V.O.)
(excitedly)
I might be getting a full ride!

AVA
That's amazing! I'm so happy for
you.
(pause)
You deserve it.

NOAH (V.O.)
I don't know about that

AVA
What do you mean? You definitely
deserve it.
(pause)
And you have this opportunity, I
don't get a chance like that.
(firmly)
You better not waste it just
because you feel like you don't
deserve it.

NOAH (V.O.)
I know, I just feel... Stuck.
(pause)
When I'm running, I feel like I'm
not stuck.

AVA
 I run in my head
 (pause)
 It's easier there

Long silence

38

INT. NOAH'S BATHROOM - EVENING

38

Noah's phone is on the counter, the time reads "8:26PM"

He's staring blankly into the mirror, gripping the counter

Multiple missed calls and messages from recruiters and other
 football related things

He glances at his forearm

Then at a partially open drawer

His phone buzzes

AVA (TEXT)
 Noah

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
 U busy?

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
 Can u call?

Ava's name and picture shows up on the screen

Hesitates before answering

AVA (V.O.)
 Noah, are you busy right now?

NOAH
 No, why? What's up?

AVA (V.O.)
 Then why didn't you answer my
 texts?

NOAH
 You gave me like 5 seconds before
 you called

AVA (V.O.)
 I guess that's a fair point
 (pause)
 (MORE)

AVA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Can you come to the window? I have
something exciting to show you.

NOAH
Yeah, I'm coming.

Noah closes the drawer and walks out of the bathroom and to
the window to look into Ava's room

Ava's sitting at her window

AVA (V.O.)
Okay, don't laugh.

NOAH
I won't.

Ava grips the window sill

Stands up, slowly, shaky

She falls back into her wheelchair, laughing slightly and
coughing a bit

NOAH (CONT'D)
Holy Shit! That's amazing!

AVA (V.O.)
Thanks, Hopefully eventually I'll
be able to stand without help from
a window.

NOAH
Yeah

Noah sits down like he's ready to talk for the next few hours

Ava stays by her window

39

EXT. FOOTBALL PRACTICE - AFTERNOON

39

Noah trying to stay focused in the huddle

He's struggling to stay focused, and runs the wrong route

Coach Reynolds pulls him aside

Noah pulls off his helmet and goes with him

COACH REYNOLDS
Noah. You okay? You're out of it
today.

NOAH
Yeah, I'm alright.

COACH REYNOLDS
You can tell me if something's
bothering you, I want to know
what's got you so distracted so I
can fix it if it's something here.

NOAH
It's not something here.

COACH REYNOLDS
Then what is it?

NOAH
Just some personal stuff

COACH REYNOLDS
Alright, go back. And lock in.

Noah nods

Puts his helmet back on

Jogs back to the huddle

40

INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

40

Ava's laying in bed and the clock is at 6:30PM

Her phone starts buzzing

She checks it and sees Noah's name and photo on her screen

She answers it

AVA
Hey, Aren't you supposed to be at
practice?

NOAH (V.O.)
Yeah... well, fuck practice, I
wanted to talk to you instead, if
you're not busy right now

AVA
(laughs)
You're gonna be in so much trouble.

NOAH (V.O.)
Yeah, well it's whatever.

He looks out his window through hers

NOAH
You look bored.

AVA
I was, but not anymore. Just don't
make it a habit of skipping
practice just to talk to me

NOAH
No promises

Time speeds up while they're talking on the phone for hours

NOAH (V.O.)
Okay, well it's getting late. Talk
to you tomorrow?

AVA
(disappointed)
Yeah, tomorrow

NOAH (V.O.)
Goodnight, Ava

AVA
Goodnight, Noah

The phone call ends and Ava lays there awake staring at the
ceiling

41 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - AFTERNOON

41

Ava's on the phone with Noah, who is at lunch at school

AVA
Noah

NOAH
Yeah?

AVA
Do you ever think about what
happens after?

NOAH
After what?

42

INTERCUT - AVA'S BEDROOM / SCHOOL CAFETERIA - AFTERNOON

42

AVA

After me

(pause)

I mean... you'll go to college,
probably forget that this house
even exists

NOAH

That's not-

She cuts him off

AVA

It's fine. That's what people do...
They move on

NOAH

What?

AVA

People move on. Or at least they
should.

NOAH

Ava... That's not what's going to
happen

AVA

Noah. It better be what happens

There's a long silence before someone speaks again

AVA (CONT'D)

Promise that you will

NOAH

I can't

AVA

Please Noah. I need you to... You
know that Travis was right before

NOAH

About what?

AVA

You told me that Travis said I'll
be gone soon enough anyway.

NOAH

He did say that... But-

AVA

No buts. He's right. So you have to promise that you'll live your life normally.

NOAH

Ava. Don't-

AVA

Fine. But don't complain when your life is miserable because you couldn't just move on like everyone else.

The bell rings for class

NOAH

I have to go to class

AVA

Okay, talk to you tonight?

NOAH

Yeah, tonight... Bye

AVA

Bye

Ava hangs up

Noah walks out of the cafeteria toward his class

43 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - EVENING

43

Another evening

Noah's sitting on his bed alone

Missed texts from Mason:

MASON (TEXT)

Where are you?

MASON (CONT'D)

You're seriously skipping practice again?

He ignores the messages and calls Ava

AVA (V.O.)

Noah.

(pause)

You skipped practice again.

NOAH

Yeah, so?

AVA (V.O.)

So... you don't do that.

NOAH

I wanted to talk to you.

AVA (V.O.)

You could've called after.

NOAH

I didn't want to wait.

AVA (V.O.)

(softer, but tense)

You don't have to keep doing that.

NOAH

Doing what?

AVA (V.O.)

Skipping things, like football practice.

(pause)

Just to sit on the phone with me.

NOAH

I like talking to you.

AVA (V.O.)

Yeah... But why?

NOAH

What do you mean why?

AVA (V.O.)

I mean, is it actually because you want to?

(pause)

Or because you feel like you have to.

NOAH

Ava.

AVA (V.O.)

Because it kinda feels like you're just here because I'm the fragile sick girl.

NOAH

That's not fair.

AVA (V.O.)
It isn't?

NOAH
No. It's not, Ava.
(pause)
I'm here because I want to be.

AVA (V.O.)
Then stop acting like I'm gonna
break every time I cough.

NOAH
I don't-

AVA (V.O.)
(cutting him off)
Yeah, you do.
(pause)
You go quiet, you choose your words
carefully, like I'm about to break.

Noah doesn't respond yet, processing everything

AVA
And then you skip practice
(pause)
Like I'm more important than the
rest of your life.

NOAH
Maybe you are.

That statement only makes it worse

AVA (V.O.)
No. I'm not.
(pause)
And I don't want to be.

NOAH
Why not?

AVA (V.O.)
Because, Noah, That's not real.
It's guilt.
(pause)
You're only here because you feel
guilty

NOAH
It's not guilt

AVA (V.O.)
Then what is it?

He doesn't have an answer yet

AVA
Yeah, that's what I thought.

NOAH
No, that's not-

AVA (V.O.)
(cutting him off)
Just stop.
(pause)
Stop talking to me just because you
feel like you have to.
(pause)
Stop treating me like I'm this
fragile thing that's gonna break.
(pause)
And stop skipping football practice

NOAH
Ava-

She hangs up

Noah puts his phone down

Stares at the ceiling

44 EXT. FOOTBALL PRACTICE - EVENING

44

Noah's practicing

He lines up

Runs a go route

Drops it

He lines up again

Runs it again

Catches it

45 INT. LOCKER ROOM - EVENING

45

Noah sits by his locker sweaty from practice

He pulls out his phone when it clears out
 He goes to his phone app
 His finger hovers over Ava's contact
 He closes the app and goes to messages instead
 He opens a text with Ava and writes:
 "I went to practice today"
 But he doesn't send it
 He deletes it
 Then he types:
 "I'm sorry"
 He hovers his thumb over send
 But deletes it instead and locks his phone
 He zones out again thinking

46

EXT. FOOTBALL FIELD - NIGHT

46

4 seconds on the clock, Noah lines up at Wide Receiver
 He runs a go route and catches the game-winning touchdown
 Ava is jumping up and down and screaming from the bleachers
 A bucket of Gatorade gets dumped on Coach Reynolds
 Noah goes over to the side line, taking off his helmet
 Ava comes down from the bleachers and runs to Noah
 Noah drops his helmet as Ava jumps into his arms
 She wraps her legs around his waist and he holds her there

47

INT. LOCKER ROOM - EVENING

47

Noah is zoned out
 Mason walks over to him waving his hand in front of his face

MASON

Noah!

Noah snaps out of it and looks at Mason

MASON (CONT'D)
You good man?

NOAH
Yeah, I'm good. Just thinking.

MASON
Alright, lock in bro

48 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

48

Noah's sitting on his bed

Clock flips from 8:29 to 8:30

Ava's bedroom light flips on

She glances at the window

Noah waves

She doesn't wave back, goes to her bed

He calls her

She hesitates, but answers the call reluctantly

AVA (V.O.)
What do you want?

NOAH
To talk.

AVA (V.O.)
We talked yesterday.

NOAH
You hung up on me.

AVA (V.O.)
Because you weren't listening to me!

NOAH
I was listening

AVA (V.O.)
No, you weren't. You were waiting to say something that would fix it.
(pause)
You don't have to fix me, Noah.

NOAH
I know that.

AVA (V.O.)
Then act like it.

Noah looks toward her window and she's not there

NOAH
Can you at least come to the
window?

She slowly rolls to the window

AVA
Fine, I'm here. Happy?

NOAH
Yes... Look Ava, I didn't skip
practice because I feel bad for you

Ava crosses her arms

AVA
Then why did you?

NOAH
Because when I'm at practice it's
not like I'm focused anyway.
(pause)
So what's the difference if I'm
here instead of there?

Ava's expression softens slightly

AVA
The difference is, that's your
life.

NOAH
It's part of it

AVA
Yeah. A really big part of it.
(pause)
Noah. I don't want to be the reason
you lose that.

NOAH
You're not making me lose anything.
(pause)
I'm not losing anything

AVA
You are if you keep choosing me
over football

NOAH
I'm not

AVA
Yes you are. You just won't admit
it.

NOAH
So what do you want? For me to just
stop talking to you?

AVA
No, But I want you to stop acting
like I'm... temporary.

NOAH
What does that even mean?

AVA
Nevermind... But you shouldn't be
shuffling your life around like
this. Not for someone who might not
even-

She cuts herself off

NOAH
Might not what?

AVA
Nothing

NOAH
No, say it.

AVA
This is exactly what I mean, Noah.
You keep pushing until it turns
into something serious like this.

NOAH
It is serious, Ava.

AVA
It doesn't have to be. Not all the
time.
(pause)
Sometimes I just want to talk about
it like it doesn't matter.

NOAH
It matters

AVA
Why?

NOAH
It matters because you matter

AVA
Don't say that.

NOAH
Why not?

AVA
(sighs)
Nevermind. Just go to practice tomorrow.

NOAH
Okay
(pause)
Goodnight, Ava.

She hesitates before responding

AVA
Goodnight.

She hangs up and rolls away from the window

49 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

49

Another night

Ava laying on her bed with her phone

She glances at the window, the blinds are closed

She opens her phone app and hovers over Noah's name

She locks her phone and sets it down beside her

AVA
(whispering to herself)
You're so stupid

She lays there for a bit before shifting to her wheelchair

She rolls over to the window and opens her blinds

She looks into Noah's room

It's dark

She writes:

"I'm sorry"

She holds it up, then puts it back down and rips it up

She hovers her pen over the notebook, but doesn't write again

A few seconds later the light in Noah's room flips on

Ava straightens up immediately

Noah sees her, barely acknowledges her

She looks down and scribbles quickly on the notebook:

"did u go to practice?"

50 INTERCUT - AVA'S BEDROOM / NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

50

Noah walks to the window and writes back:

"yeah"

Ava exhales, relieved

She writes:

"Good"

He doesn't respond yet

Ava writes again:

"I'm sorry"

Noah writes:

"Can u call?"

She nods and gets her phone and calls him quickly

AVA
I'm sorry, Noah

NOAH
For which part?

AVA
All of it.

NOAH

I'm sorry too, you weren't wrong...
About some of it.

AVA

I was being a bitch about it

NOAH

It's fine, Ava.

AVA

It's not.

(pause)

I just... don't want to be a
problem for you.

NOAH

You're not a problem

AVA

So you're going to practice
tomorrow too?

NOAH

Okay. Fine, I'll go to practice,
but as soon as I'm back, we'll
call?

AVA

Deal.

NOAH

Ava, you know that I actually like
talking to you, and that it's not
because I "feel bad", right?

AVA

Yeah, I know. It's just... like I
said before... I didn't want to be
a problem

NOAH

You never have been, and you never
will be.

AVA

Thank you, Noah. I really needed to
hear that... Goodnight.

NOAH

Goodnight.

Noah goes to bed now and Ava does the same

Ava lays back in bed, looking happier

51

INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

51

Another night

Her lights are dim, she seems more tired tonight

She plugs in her phone which shows it's dead

She goes to the window with a sign

She writes and holds up:

"My phone died"

Noah writes, then holds up:

"Ok"

Ava writes:

"Do you think God plans everything?"

Noah writes back:

"I used to"

Ava thinks, then writes:

"What changed?"

He hesitates, then writes:

"I prayed for something important once. didn't happen"

Ava writes back:

"What was it?"

Noah writes again:

"My grandma had cancer. She died"

Ava takes her time writing the next one:

"I don't think he plans it all"

Noah looks confused through the window

Ava holds up the next page:

"I just think he doesn't waste anything"

He looks at her and thinks for a couple seconds
The wind outside picks up and it starts raining
Ava checks her phone and it's lit up
Her lockscreen shows 9:18PM
She calls Noah

AVA
My dad left when I was twelve.

NOAH (V.O.)
I'm sorry

AVA
He didn't leave because he didn't
love me
(pause)
He left because he got tired.

NOAH (V.O.)
You miss him?

AVA
I miss who he was before he got
tired of me, not the piece of shit
he is now.
(pause)
That's why I told you I like
stories where people stay

Long silence

NOAH (V.O.)
Yeah. I like those stories too

AVA
I don't think God would've planned
for him to leave. But I don't think
he's wasting this situation either.

NOAH (V.O.)
Yeah

Another long pause

AVA
You know, I thought you would've
left by now too. It's already been
like 4 months and you're still
here.

NOAH (V.O.)
I told you, I'm not leaving.

52 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - MORNING 52

Noah quietly getting ready for school
He glances over at Ava's bedroom window
Her room is dark, rain is pouring outside
Noah reaches for his backpack
Walks out of his room

53 EXT. NOAH'S DRIVEWAY - MORNING 53

Noah comes out of his house
Starts walking to his car
He sees Ava outside in the rain in her wheelchair

NOAH
Ava?

Ava turns her head and sees Noah

AVA
Oh, hi.

NOAH
What are you doing out here?

AVA
I couldn't stay inside anymore, it
was killing me

NOAH
Yeah, well this is too. Maybe you
should go back inside

He starts to walk over to her

Ava sighs and looks up, rain hitting her face, thinking

AVA
Five more minutes?

NOAH
No, Ava

She looks down, then up to Noah

AVA

Fine. I guess you're right. Help me?

NOAH

Yeah

Noah pushes her wheelchair to her front door

He opens the door

Pushes her inside

The door closes behind them

54 EXT. OUTSIDE SCHOOL - AFTERNOON

54

After school, the lot is mostly empty

Noah stands by his car

Mason, Emma, Jess, and Nick all walk out in a group, laughing and talking

NICK

Yo Noah! You coming to hang out later?

Noah hesitates

NOAH

Yeah

Emma notices the hesitation, but doesn't comment on it

EMMA

Okay, see you then!

Noah gets in his car and leaves

Emma turns to the others

EMMA (CONT'D)

He hesitated.

MASON

So?

EMMA

So, why did he hesitate?

JESS

Probably just thinking to make sure
he didn't have anything else
planned?

EMMA

He's always hesitating now. Ever
since he met that girl next door to
him.

NICK

(teasingly)
Aw, is somebody jealous?

EMMA

No. I'm not jealous. Just...
worried.

JESS

What is there to be worried about?

EMMA

His future, he literally hit Travis
and got suspended over her. She
can't be that important.

MASON

She can be to him.

They all keep walking and split off from each other

EMMA

(under her breath)
She shouldn't be.

55 INT. RESTAURANT - EVENING

55

Everyone's there but Noah

Emma looks around nervously

EMMA

Where is he?

NICK

Chill, he said he'll be here

Noah walks in and sits down

MASON

Hey Noah

NOAH

Hi

JESS

(whispering to Emma)

I told you

Emma elbows Jess under the table

EMMA

You're late.

NOAH

Yeah, I know

EMMA

You said you'd be here

NOAH

I am here

EMMA

Now you are... where were you?

NOAH

Out

NICK

Out where?

NOAH

Why does it matter?

EMMA

Because you've been acting weird

NOAH

I'm not acting weird

EMMA

You hesitated earlier when we asked
if you'd be here

NOAH

That doesn't mean anything

EMMA

It does when it's every time now

JESS

Guys-

Emma cuts her off

EMMA

Seriously, Noah. Ever since you met her, it's like nothing else matters to you anymore

NOAH

That's not true

EMMA

Then why? What's wrong?

(pause)

Because from my point of view, it looks like you're just throwing everything away

NICK

She kinda has a point

NOAH

No. She doesn't

MASON

You literally got suspended

NOAH

I know

MASON

Over her

EMMA

She can't be that important, Noah.

NOAH

You don't know shit about her.

EMMA

Then tell us

NOAH

It's not your business

EMMA

It is when it's affecting us too

Jess notices Emma overstepping and pushing

JESS

Emma-

EMMA

What? I'm just trying to understand

NOAH
No you aren't.

EMMA
Then help me understand. What makes
her worth all of this

Noah's breathing shifts, he loses his composure

NOAH
You think she wanted this?

EMMA
Wanted what?

NOAH
The disease, to be stuck inside,
for her dad to leave just cause he
'got tired'

The others all look up, wide eyed

Noah immediately regrets letting it slip out

EMMA
What?

NOAH
(under his breath)
Shit

MASON
Her dad left?

NOAH
It's not- that's not-
(pause)
It's not your business

EMMA
You never mentioned that before

NOAH
Like I said. It's not your business

Everyone's quiet now.

NOAH (CONT'D)
(under his breath)
I shouldn't have said that

EMMA
Noah

NOAH

Drop it.

Noah stands up abruptly

NICK

Bro, you just got here

NOAH

Yeah, and now I'm leaving.

He turns to walk out

JESS

Wait-

She gets cut off by the door closing behind Noah

56 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

56

Thunder outside, wind and rain hitting the windows

Ava's phone is plugged in on her nightstand, so they're doing the signs again

Ava laughs at something Noah writes, but it turns to coughing

She looks down

There's a kink in the oxygen tube where it's caught on the arm of her wheelchair

She adjusts it, then the airflow returns to normal

NOAH

(mouthing)

You okay?

Ava nods quickly

She holds up a sign:

"When I get out, we're marathoning Harry Potter outside"

Noah writes:

"Deal"

Ava writes back:

"No complaining"

Noah writes back:

"No promises"

She laughs again, this turns into a cough, worse than normal

INTERCUT:

57 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

57

While she's coughing he looks away to write a note:

"I think I'm falling for U"

But he doesn't hold it up yet

NOAH
You sure you're good?

Ava nods again, but she's still coughing

NOAH (CONT'D)
Ava?

She tries to answer, but can't

She starts coughing harder and falls out of frame

Noah freezes for half a second, dropping the note

NOAH (CONT'D)
Ava?!
(short pause)
Shit.

Thunder crashes outside

He runs down the stairs

58 EXT. STREET - NIGHT

58

Noah throws his front door open

His driveway is empty

Noah runs to her front door and starts knocking loudly

Claire opens the door and sees Noah soaked at her door

CLAIRE
Hello? Noah?

NOAH

It's Ava... She collapsed in her
room

Claire and Noah run up to Ava's room

Claire calls 911 in the background

Noah kneels beside Ava

Sirens sound in the distance

A couple minutes later EMTs rush in

Noah steps back from Ava to let the EMTs work

59 INT. CAR ON THE WAY TO HOSPITAL - NIGHT

59

Claire is driving fast

Noah's in the passenger seat

Noah looks out the window at the rain

60 INT. HOSPITAL WAITING ROOM - NIGHT

60

Noah is sitting there alone, soaked

He overhears a doctor speaking

DOCTOR SMITH

She's gone

Noah assumes they're talking about Ava

His breath catches in his throat

Tears form in his eyes as he sits there for a few seconds

Another doctor walks into the room

DOCTOR HIGGINS

You're here for Ava Bennett?

NOAH

Yes

DOCTOR HIGGINS

She's stable. We're still waiting
on a diagnosis. Her mother is in
the room with her now.

Doctor Higgins points to a hall
Noah calms slightly at this news

NOAH
Thank you

He gets up and walks into the hall

61 INT. HOSPITAL ICU - NIGHT

61

Machines humming

Ava lies in bed unconscious, her chest moving mechanically

Noah stands in the doorway still soaked

Claire sits beside Ava's bed holding her hand

DOCTOR SMITH
(quietly to Claire)
She's in severe respiratory
failure. Her lungs are barely
functioning

Noah listens without meaning to

DOCTOR SMITH (CONT'D)
She needs a bilateral lung
transplant

Claire nods like she understands

DOCTOR SMITH (CONT'D)
The waitlist for her blood type is
long. Without that transplant we're
talking days at most.

Claire breaks down crying, still holding Ava's hand

Noah's jaw tightens and he stares at the ventilator, blinking
hard

He walks out of the room into the hall

62 INT. HOSPITAL STAIRWELL - NIGHT

62

Heavy metal door slams shut as Noah enters

Silence

He runs his hand through his wet hair

He hits the metal railing, which causes his hand to bleed slightly and causes a loud echo of the metal, he doesn't care

He grips the railing

NOAH

Don't do this. Don't take her.

He leans against the wall and slides down, hyperventilating

NOAH (CONT'D)

Why would you do this? Why would you let her hurt like this?

He tries to control his breathing slowly and closes his eyes

One tear slips out

Clasps his hands together

NOAH (CONT'D)

God, I don't know if you're listening or if you're even real... But if you are, please don't take her... I'll do anything, God... I need her to be okay. I can't lose her.

He stands up and slowly goes out of the stairwell

63

INT. HOSPITAL HALLWAY - NIGHT

63

Noah stands alone against the wall

He's watching film on his phone

It rings and shows Coach Reynolds Caller ID

He hesitates, but answers

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)

Where were you today? Rain doesn't mean practice is cancelled.

NOAH

I know, I didn't skip cause of the rain. I'm at the hospital.

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)

Oh, I didn't know that... Are you okay?

NOAH
Yeah, I'm good. I'm not here for me

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
Family?

NOAH
A friend
(pause)
She has a lung disease, and she's
not doing well right now

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
I'm sorry to hear that... I do have
some news that might make you feel
a bit better though.

NOAH
What is it?

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
I just got off the phone with a
recruiter
(pause)
He's coming Friday. In person. To
see you play
(pause)
You play like you did last week,
and that offer you got is almost
guaranteed.

Noah looks toward Ava's ICU room

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
This is everything you've worked
for, kid.

NOAH
I know

COACH REYNOLDS (V.O.)
Show up to practice tomorrow.

Coach Reynolds hangs up

Noah puts his phone away and turns slightly

He hears two doctors speaking quietly around the corner

DOCTOR SMITH (O.S.)
If we had two living donors, we
could attempt a lobar transplant.

Noah turns slightly more to hear them

DOCTOR HIGGINS (O.S.)
It's rare. Major surgery. Both
donors lose about twenty to thirty
percent permanent lung capacity

DOCTOR SMITH (O.S.)
Athletes wouldn't be able to play
anymore

Noah doesn't move

DOCTOR HIGGINS (O.S.)
But it's faster than waiting for
cadaver lungs.

Noah glances into the window and sees Ava laying there, then
back to his phone

He glances into the ICU window

Claire next to her holding her hand

As he sees her laying there the monitor spikes once, then
returns to normal

He locks his phone and puts it in his pocket

He takes a deep breath in and goes around the corner

He goes up to the doctors

NOAH
How do I get tested?

Doctor Smith and Doctor Higgins look at him confused

DOCTOR SMITH
What?

NOAH
For the lung donation transplant,
For Ava.

DOCTOR HIGGINS
Are you her family?

NOAH
No
(pause)
But can't we test anyway?
The doctors exchange a look

DOCTOR HIGGINS
Don't you play football?

NOAH

Yeah, so?

DOCTOR SMITH

Kid, if you were a match. You wouldn't play football ever again.

NOAH

I know, I heard.

DOCTOR HIGGINS

You're still a minor. You'd need parental consent even to get tested for compatibility.

NOAH

Okay

Noah nods and walks away to call his parents, Julia and David

JULIA (V.O.)

Hi, Noah. We're almost home if that's why you're calling.

NOAH

That's not why... I'm at the hospital, can you and Dad come?

JULIA (V.O.)

(panicked)

What? Why? Are you hurt?

NOAH

No. I'm fine.

JULIA (V.O.)

Then what's going on?

Noah glances back to the ICU doors, then back to the phone

NOAH

I just need you both to come. Now.

JULIA (V.O.)

We're on the way now.

Noah hangs up, then just looks back into the ICU

Mostly empty, Noah sits in a chair, his head in his hands

Julia and David rush in

JULIA
Are you okay?

She grabs his face, checking him

DAVID
What happened? Did you get into a
fight again? Are you okay?

NOAH
No. I'm fine.

His parents look confused

DAVID
Then why are we here?

Noah takes a breath

NOAH
There's a girl.

JULIA
A girl... Ava?

NOAH
Yeah. She lives next to us... She's
in the ICU

Julia and David's confusion turns to concern

DAVID
Okay? This is the girl you've been
talking to?

NOAH
Yes. She needs a lung transplant

JULIA
And?

Noah looks them both in the eyes

NOAH
They can do a living Lobar
Transplant.
(pause)
She'd need two donors.

DAVID
(sternly)
No.

NOAH
They can test me

JULIA
Noah.

NOAH
She has days

DAVID
And that is tragic. But it's not
your responsibility.

NOAH
Then whose is it?!

The few people in the waiting room turn heads at the yell

DAVID
You barely even know this girl!

NOAH
I know her well enough!
(pause)
I know she hates when people pity
her. I know she pretends her lungs
don't hurt when they do. I know she
runs in her head because she can't
in real life.

JULIA
You've known her for what, a few
months?

NOAH
4... Long enough!

DAVID
Long enough to throw away your
future?!

NOAH
It's not throwing it away!

DAVID
You will never play football again!

NOAH
I know!

JULIA
You worked your whole life for
this. Every camp, every practice,
every injury

NOAH

Exactly, and what's the point of it
if I'm not doing something that
actually matters!

DAVID

Football Matters!

NOAH

Not more than her life!

His father steps closer now

DAVID

You are seventeen. You do not get
to make a permanent decision like
this over a girl you just met.

Noah steps forward too, so they're eye to eye

NOAH

I already did.

JULIA

Noah. Honey... You're scared,
you're reacting.

NOAH

I'm not scared. Not anymore.
Before, I didn't actually care.
None of it actually mattered.

(pause)

Not football, not school. It all
just felt like something I was
supposed to do.

He looks down, then back up

NOAH (CONT'D)

Then I met her through the window.
And I'm not saying everything just
magically got better, but I just...
Before her, none of it felt real.

(pause)

So no, I'm not just reacting. This
is the first thing I've been really
sure about in a long time.

(softer now)

And I can't lose her... I love her.

DAVID

You love her?

NOAH

Yes.

DAVID

Enough to quit football entirely

NOAH

Yes! Enough to quit anything.
Everything.

JULIA

What if something happens to you?

NOAH

Then something happens. I don't
care.

Tears start to well up in Julia's eyes

DAVID

You're our son.

NOAH

And she's someone's daughter!

(long pause)

You taught me to be strong, to show
up, to not walk away. So don't ask
me to walk away now.

DAVID

You don't understand what you're
giving up

NOAH

I do. I understand perfectly.

(pause)

They said I won't play again.

JULIA

And you still want to do this?

NOAH

Yes.

DAVID

Why?

NOAH

Because I told her I wasn't
leaving.

Silence for several seconds

DAVID
If we sign this, your life changes.

NOAH
It already did.

Julia grips Noah's hand tightly and her tears fall freely
David finally looks at Noah again
Noah doesn't move
Julia looks at him like she's already imagining the scar

JULIA
(whispering)
You shouldn't do this.

NOAH
I'm doing it.

David gently places his hand on Julia's shoulder

DAVID
We need the paperwork.

Doctor Smith approaches with the papers and a pen
David and Julia sign the papers
Noah watches them sign everything
Finally, Julia steps forward and hugs Noah carefully as if he
could break at any moment
She rests her head on his shoulder for just a second

JULIA
(whispering)
Come back to me

Noah wraps his arms around her firmly

NOAH
I will

Over Julia's shoulder Noah and David lock eyes
David Nods slightly

Noah sits beside Ava's bed holding her hand

In the other hand he's holding a worn copy of Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone

He reads quietly

He looks at her

NOAH

You still owe me an explanation
about this whole Horcrux thing.

The machines continue breathing for her

He sets the book down and adjusts a strand of hair from her face while being careful not to disturb the tubes

66 EXT. OUTSIDE HOSPITAL - NIGHT

66

Not raining, but still cloudy, dark, and windy

Noah stands alone

He looks up to the sky

NOAH

I don't know if you're listening.
(pause)
But I'm here

He struggles to find the words to say

NOAH (CONT'D)

Take whatever you want from me,
just don't take her.

The wind blows and he stands there longer than he needs to

67 INT. HOSPITAL WAITING ROOM - MORNING

67

Noah sits in a chair quietly leaning forward

His phone buzzes, but he ignores it

It buzzes again

He checks it to find two texts from Mason

MASON (TEXT)

Noah

MASON (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Why aren't u at film study?

Noah types back

NOAH (TEXT)

Busy

Typing bubbles show up

MASON (TEXT)

You never miss film studies

NOAH (TEXT)

It's important. Can't make it today

Noah locks his phone and puts it away

68

INT. HOSPITAL FAMILY CONSULT ROOM - MORNING

68

Soft morning light filters in through half-closed blinds

Noah sits with claire

Claire is holding a cup of untouched coffee

She doesn't know Noah's getting tested yet

DOCTOR HIGGINS

We can begin compatibility testing
for living donors immediately. But
she would need two compatible
donors for a lobar transplant, and
the chances of that are slim to
none.

Claire looks at Noah for the first time since that night

Noah looks back at her

NOAH

I'm getting tested

Claire looks at him alarmed now

CLAIRE

No.

NOAH

It's just testing

CLAIRE

You're a child

NOAH

I'm seventeen

CLAIRE

Exactly

Noah's parents stay quiet

CLAIRE (CONT'D)

You think I could live with myself
if something happened to you?

NOAH

(defensive)

You think I could live with myself
if I didn't at least try to help
her?

CLAIRE

She wouldn't want this

NOAH

She wouldn't want to die either

Claire closes her eyes briefly

CLAIRE

You barely know her

NOAH

I know enough

(pause)

She told me she likes stories where
people stay.

Claire just stares into space

MONTAGE - DONOR SEARCH:

--Church bulletin board with a typed notice: "Urgent donor
testing needed"

--A few teenagers at school whispering about it

--A man in his 30s rolling up his sleeve for bloodwork

--A middle-aged woman shaking her head gently as a nurse
explains she isn't compatible

--Noah sitting quietly during testing

--Cole seeing Noah's post

--Another potential donor leaving the office disappointed

CLAIRE
 (whispering)
 People are trying, baby

END MONTAGE

69 INT. HOSPITAL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

69

Doctor Higgins approaches Claire and Noah

DOCTOR HIGGINS
 We had several volunteers tested
 (pause)
 Two were incompatible. One had
 underlying health issues that
 disqualify him.

Claire's face falls slightly

Noah nods

DOCTOR HIGGINS (CONT'D)
 We're still waiting on a few more
 results.

70 INT. HOSPITAL BLOOD DRAW ROOM - EVENING

70

Noah sits across from Cole

They both get blood drawn

71 INT. HOSPITAL FAMILY CONSULT ROOM - EVENING

71

Doctor Smith enters with a folder

DOCTOR SMITH
 Noah is a match
 (pause)
 We also have a second compatible
 donor

CLAIRE
 Who?

Cole walks in, already uncomfortable with the attention

He keeps his hands in his hoodie pockets

COLE
 Hey

Claire slowly stands

CLAIRE
You don't even know her.

Cole shrugs

COLE
My mom saw the post. Figured I
should get tested, she said I'd
regret not trying. Didn't think I'd
match.

CLAIRE
Why would you do this

COLE
Because I can.
(pause)
And I know what it's like to wait.
(pause)
My... friend died waiting for a
transplant.

Noah looks over at him

He turns to the doctor

COLE (CONT'D)
But I don't want anyone to know
about this.

DOCTOR SMITH
Of course. Donor confidentiality is
protected.

COLE
Good

He looks to Claire again

COLE (CONT'D)
She doesn't owe me anything. I
don't want visits. Or attention...
Just let it help

CLAIRE
Thank you.

He nods once awkwardly

COLE
Yeah

He turns to Noah

COLE (CONT'D)
I guess we're doing this.

Noah nods

DOCTOR SMITH
I'll be honest. Finding two viable
donors in this time frame is very
rare.

Claire closes her eyes and tilts her head up

CLAIRE
(whispering)
Thank you

Cole leaves the room but turns back once

COLE
Just let me know when.

Then he leaves

72 INT. HOSPITAL PRE-OP AREA - EARLY MORNING

72

Dim morning light through the windows

Three separate rooms, Noah in one, Cole in another, Ava in
the other

Julia and David are with Noah

DAVID
You don't have to be fearless.

NOAH
I know. I'm not. I'm just not
leaving either.

A nurse wheels Noah to the OR, in the hall he sees Ava
through the glass of her room

He reaches his hand slightly toward the glass as he passes

MONTAGE - SURGERY

--Surgeons scrubbing in

--Ava being prepped

--Noah staring at the ceiling lights

--Cole staring at the same lights in another room
 --Claire clutching a cross necklace in the waiting room
 --Julia gripping David's hand tightly

NURSE 1
 Count back from ten

NOAH
 Ten, Nine, Eight

COLE
 Seven, Six, Five

END MONTAGE

73 INT. OPERATING ROOM - AFTERNOON

73

Monitors beeping steadily, surgeons working
 Ava's monitor shifts and the beeping changes

NURSE 1
 We're losing sinus rhythm

SURGEON
 Push epi, Increase oxygen

Her heart rate spikes dangerously for five seconds
 Flatline

NURSE 2
 We're losing her

INTERCUT:

74 INT. DANCE RECITAL STAGE - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

74

Eight year old Ava stands center stage in a pale pink tutu
 Her hair is pulled into a tight bun, ballet slippers soft
 against the polished wood
 Delicate piano music is playing through the theater
 She dances happily
 In the audience is her father, Michael

INTERCUT:

75 INT. OPERATING ROOM - AFTERNOON

75

SURGEON
Start compressions. Now.

A nurse begins chest compressions

NURSE 1
Charging to 200

Defibrillator paddles press to her chest

SURGEON
Clear!

The flatline continues after the shock

INTERCUT:

76 INT. DANCE STUDIO - MORNING (FLASHBACK)

76

Sunlight through tall windows

Little Ava stands in front of a mirror practicing her dances

Claire watching

She spins and stumbles

AVA
Shit

CLAIRE
Language, Ava

AVA
Sorry, Mommy. I keep falling

CLAIRE
It's okay, baby. Try again.

She tries again and lands it perfectly with a smile

INTERCUT:

77 INT. OPERATING ROOM - AFTERNOON

77

The flatline continues

Compressions Continue

NURSE 2
No response

SURGEON
Again. Charge.

The defibrillator charges up

NURSE 1
Ready

SURGEON
Clear!

They shock her and her body jolts, but the flatline continues

INTERCUT:

78 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

78

Rain tapping against glass

Noah holds up a paper to the window "Still here"

Ava writes and holds up her own paper "Obviously"

Noah writes another page "You ever get tired of me?"

Ava pretends to think about it, then writes "Not yet"

Noah thinks for a couple seconds, then writes "Good. cuz I'm not leaving"

Ava lowers her paper, and nods slowly

Rain keeps falling outside

INTERCUT:

79 INT. OPERATING ROOM - AFTERNOON

79

SURGEON
Clear!

They shock her again, this time the tone breaks

One beep

Then another

NURSE 2
We've got a pulse.

Short pause

SURGEON
Okay, Let's continue

They continue the surgery

80 INT. HOSPITAL WAITING ROOM - EVENING

80

Claire, David, Julia, and Cole's parents are all sitting together staring into space waiting

Surgeon enters the room

Everyone stands

SURGEON
The procedures were successful.
They're all stable.

Julia hugs David, and Cole's parents hug

Claire sits down again

81 INT. RECOVERY ROOM - EVENING

81

Cole wakes first

COLE
How'd it go?

NURSE 1
Everything went well. Do you want to stay and wait for her to wake up?

COLE
No. I want to get out of here before either of them wake up if possible.

NURSE 1
Okay

The nurse helps Cole up and out of the room carefully

He exits the room and inhales deeply

He looks back once, then leaves

After a few more minutes, Noah wakes up

He winces slightly as he tries to sit up

The nurse notices

NURSE 1 (CONT'D)
Easy there buddy. Surgery went
well.

Noah looks over to Ava

NOAH
Her?

NURSE 1
Still Sedated, but stable.

Noah feels the limitation of his breathing now

DISSOLVE TO:

82 INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - AFTERNOON

82

Days later

Ava lies in bed asleep, but without a ventilator now, just a
nasal cannula

Noah's sitting in the chair next to her bed, breathing slowly
while reading again

NOAH
You're missing the good part, Ava.

He keeps reading

DISSOLVE TO:

83 INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - MORNING

83

Soft morning light, monitors humming low, Ava still asleep

Claire and Noah are both there

Claire's asleep, Noah's in a chair looking out the window

Ava starts to wake up

Claire hears Ava and jolts awake

Noah looks over to Ava

CLAIRE

Ava?

AVA

W- What... Happened?

Claire immediately grabs her hand

CLAIRE

You're okay. You're okay!

Ava frowns as she remembers the night when she passed out

She looks at Noah, who is now looking at her

AVA

You're here.

NOAH

I told you I'm not leaving

She puts her hand on her chest

Ava takes another deep breath

AVA

Why doesn't it... hurt?

Ava moves her legs slightly, testing her body

AVA (CONT'D)

I can... I can breathe

Ava looks at Noah's face

AVA (CONT'D)

You look... tired.

Ava's eyes drop to his chest and she notices the scar where it's slightly visible above his shirt

Her eyes widen

AVA (CONT'D)

What happened to you?

NOAH

You needed new lungs.

AVA

No.

(pause)

No... That's not- No

Claire squeezes Ava's hand

CLAIRE
Baby

AVA
No.

She realizes what he did and she looks closer at the surgical marks by his collarbone, then back to his face

AVA (CONT'D)
You didn't.

NOAH
You needed two donors.

AVA
You... You can't play though

Ava starts breathing faster now

AVA (CONT'D)
Why would you do that?! I didn't ask you to do that!

Tears start to spill down her face

She tries to push herself up, and she winces hard

NOAH
Hey.. Hey, Careful.

He moves closer while speaking

She cuts him off

AVA
You had everything! You were supposed to leave! You were supposed to go somewhere!
(pause)
And now you're stuck... Because of me.

NOAH
I told you I wasn't leaving, and it's not your fault. I made my choice.

Tears spill down Ava's face

AVA
You can't play now! You can't play
in the championship! You can't play
in college!

NOAH
I know

AVA
You don't get to decide that!

NOAH
Yeah, I do.

AVA
I don't want to be the reason you
give up on your dream! You promised
you wouldn't slow down for me!

NOAH
I'm not slowing down. Just...
changing direction.

Ava stares at him through her tears

AVA
What if something happens to you?

She starts to panic

AVA (CONT'D)
What if one day you wake up and
can't breathe either?!

NOAH
Then it happens. But you'll get to
breathe.

AVA
Why would you do that? You
shouldn't have done this, Noah.

NOAH
Ava, I told you I wasn't leaving.

Ava takes a deep breath

AVA
It's quiet. It's never quiet.

Claire also starts crying now

Ava looks at Noah, her expression softens

AVA (CONT'D)
Was it worth it?

Noah watches Ava take another full breath

NOAH
Yeah

He finally reaches out and holds her hand

She squeezes back, not letting go

He leans toward the bed and hugs her gently

84 INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - EVENING

84

Ava's in her bed

Noah's in the corner in the chair

Claire is sitting there too

A Nurse is there

CLAIRE
I'm going to get some food for us
all

Okay NOAH Okay AVA

Claire walks out of the room

Ava sits up

AVA (CONT'D)
Can you help me get up, please?

NURSE 1
Yes, careful though

Nurse 1 helps Ava swing her legs off the bed

Ava takes a deep breath

AVA
You can let go

NURSE 1
Are you sure?

AVA
Yes, let go.

Ava tries to stand

She collapses back onto the bed, frustrated

She lays there staring at the ceiling

AVA (CONT'D)
Why can't I do this?

NURSE 1
Your body's relearning everything

AVA
I used to dance
(pause)
Then I couldn't stand at all
(pause)
Now I'm "better" and I still can't
even stand

NURSE 1
It'll take time

AVA
(to herself now)
This is stupid... I can breathe...
Why can't I do anything else?

Noah looks over not knowing if he should try to help

He takes a step toward Ava

She snaps

AVA (CONT'D)
Sit down.

Noah sits back down

AVA (CONT'D)
I don't need help with everything!

There's a long silence

AVA (CONT'D)
Sorry

NOAH
It's alright

The room is dim, Ava's in her bed, staring at the ceiling

AVA
(to herself)
Why can't I stand?

She turns to the window and looks outside

She takes a full deep breath

AVA (CONT'D)
At least there's that

She closes her eyes

86 INT. HOSPITAL REHAB HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

86

Ava walking slowly with a nurse and walker, with an oxygen tank rolling beside her

Noah is at the far end of the hall pretending he just happened to be there

AVA
Are you stalking me now?

NOAH
Doctor said you're not allowed to fall.

AVA
(teasingly)
You're not allowed to hover

She takes three more steps with a smile

87 INT. HOSPITAL BATHROOM - AFTERNOON

87

Ava is standing by the sink looking into the mirror

She lifts her shirt slightly to see the scars

She traces the marks

88 INT. HOSPITAL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

88

Noah is walking through the hall, slowly

His chest gets tight and his breathing slows

He braces himself against the wall

NOAH

Damn it

A nurse sees and goes up to him

NURSE 2

You need to take it easy

NOAH

I used to run for hours, easily

He slowly walks back to the hospital room

89 INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - NIGHT

89

Ava's asleep in her bed

Noah's sitting there alone

Claire is asleep in a chair

Noah tries to take a deep breath but struggles

He tries again, still struggling

NOAH

(whispering)

Come on.

He looks at the window and sees the reflection of Ava in her bed, breathing perfectly

He smiles and closes his eyes

90 INT. AVA'S HOUSE - AFTERNOON

90

Claire helping Ava up the stairs

She pauses half way

CLAIRE

You okay?

Ava nods

AVA

I don't feel like I'm drowning anymore

91

EXT. FOOTBALL FIELD - AFTERNOON

91

Noah stands alone on the sideline

He looks onto the empty field

He walks to the line, gets into his stance

He starts trying to run, slow, unsteady

His breathing tightens and he slows down even more

He clutches his side

NOAH
(to himself)
Shit

He walks slowly back to the line, takes a second to rest

He starts trying to run again, his breathing is worse now

He holds his side again

NOAH (CONT'D)
(to himself)
I should be able to do this

He walks slowly to the bleachers and sits down

His head fills with the sounds of whistles and pads crashing together

He zones out for a bit, thinking about football

Mason comes over

MASON
Yo, Noah

NOAH
Hey, bro

Mason sits next to Noah

MASON
So... You donated your lung?

NOAH
Part of it.

MASON
You good?

NOAH

Yeah.

MASON

You sure?

Noah Shrugs

MASON (CONT'D)

You're allowed to be scared, you know

NOAH

I'm not scared, Just gonna miss football. I probably won't play again.

92 INT. NOAH'S KITCHEN - EVENING

92

Noah walks into the kitchen, out of breath

David sees him but says nothing at first

Noah sits down at the table and rests his head in his hands

NOAH

(under his breath)

This is so stupid

DAVID

I told you you'd regret it.

NOAH

I don't regret it

DAVID

Then what's this about?

NOAH

I miss being able to run and everything else, but that doesn't mean I regret my choice.

(pause)

You would've done the same if it was mom, right?

DAVID

Yes, I would. But that's different. You two aren't even together

NOAH

I was going to ask her out right before she passed out

DAVID
You were?

NOAH
Yes, but now I just... I don't know
when to ask her.

DAVID
Son, if you're waiting for the
perfect time to ask her, it's never
going to happen. You just have to
go for it when it feels right.

93 INT. CLAIRE'S CAR ON THE WAY TO PT - AFTERNOON 93

Claire is driving

Ava's in the passenger seat

AVA
I hate this

CLAIRE
I know, but it'll be worth it.

AVA
I know that... But still

Claire parks the car

Helps Ava get out of the car

They walk into Physical Therapy slowly.

94 INT. PHYSICAL THERAPY OFFICE - AFTERNOON 94

Ava sits in the waiting room

Claire checks in

A few minutes later, DOCTOR HANNAH walks out

DOCTOR HANNAH
Ava Bennett?

Claire helps Ava up

They slowly walk back with Doctor Hannah

95

INT. CLAIRE'S CAR ON THE WAY HOME - AFTERNOON

95

Claire's driving

Ava's in the passenger seat holding her phone

AVA

Mom, don't you have work tomorrow?

CLAIRE

I do. I can't take you to physical therapy

(pause)

Can you see if someone can take you?

AVA

I'll text Noah

CLAIRE

Okay

Ava opens the messages app and goes to Noah's contact

AVA (TEXT)

My mom has work tmr 🙄

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Can u take me to pt?

She waits a couple seconds

The typing bubble shows up

NOAH (TEXT)

Yeah

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)

What time?

AVA (TEXT)

12

NOAH (TEXT)

👍

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Alr, see u then

Ava puts her phone away and stares out the window

96

INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - EVENING

96

Ava's laying in bed

She swings her legs off slowly

She tries to stand, but falls to the ground

AVA

Shit

She lays there on the floor

She puts her hands on her face and screams into them

AVA (CONT'D)

This is so stupid! I should be able
to stand!

She lays there a few seconds longer before pulling herself up
on the bed

She manages to get into bed again

She lays there and starts quietly crying

Across the gap, Noah's light flips on and he looks over to
Ava's room

Noah sees her on the bed crying and texts her

Her phone lights up and she checks it

NOAH (TEXT)

U ok?

AVA (TEXT)

I'm fine

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)

I tried to stand and couldn't

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Just being dramatic

NOAH (TEXT)

Oh, ok

Ava glances at her clock and realizes it's 10:43PM

AVA (TEXT)

It's late.

NOAH (TEXT)
Yeah, ik

AVA (TEXT)
Gn

NOAH (TEXT)
Goodnight

97 INT. NOAH'S CAR ON THE WAY TO PT - AFTERNOON

97

Noah's driving

Ava's in the passenger seat

Noah parks in the parking lot

AVA
Thanks for bringing me

NOAH
You need help getting out?

AVA
I got it

Noah gets out of the car

After Ava gets out he tries to support her as they walk

AVA (CONT'D)
I said I got it

Despite her words, she leans slightly on him

NOAH
I know you do... I'm just making
sure you don't fall

AVA
(teasingly)
You're the one we should be worried
about here

Noah pretends to stumble

NOAH
Yeah, definitely

Ava laughs

AVA
(playfully)
You're so stupid

They walk into the physical therapy office

98

INT. PHYSICAL THERAPY OFFICE - AFTERNOON

98

DOCTOR HANNAH
Ava! Come on in, we're ready for
you now

AVA
Thank you

Noah goes to sit down

AVA (CONT'D)
You can come too

Noah looks to Doctor Hannah

She gives him a nod

NOAH
Okay

Noah gets up and walks back with them

Doctor Hannah helps Ava hold onto a bar

She takes a few steps

She lets go of the bar and starts to wobble

DOCTOR HANNAH
Careful, don't let go if you're not
ready

AVA
I know. I wish I was ready though

DOCTOR HANNAH
If your body's not ready, don't
push it

AVA
Okay

Doctor Hannah helps Ava take a few more steps

99 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - AFTERNOON

99

The bedroom is empty

JULIA (O.S.)
Noah!

Julia walks into the room

She looks around and notices a paper by the window

JULIA (CONT'D)
(to herself)
Right... he took Ava to Physical
Therapy

She walks over and picks up the paper and looks at it

She flips it over and it says "I think I'm falling for U"

She stares at it for a few seconds trying to understand

JULIA (CONT'D)
Ava

She lays it face up on Noah's bed and walks out of the room

100 INT. NOAH'S CAR ON THE WAY HOME - AFTERNOON

100

Noah's driving

Ava's in the passenger seat

NOAH
Good job

AVA
Don't.

NOAH
Don't what?

AVA
Don't lie and tell me I did good

NOAH
But you did-

Ava cuts him off

AVA
No, I fell like 5 times.

NOAH
Okay, do you want to talk about
something else?

AVA
Can we just listen to the music?

NOAH
Yeah

He turns up the volume on the music a bit

101 EXT. NOAH'S DRIVEWAY - EVENING

101

Noah pulls into the driveway
He gets out and helps Ava to her house
He opens the door for her and helps support her

102 INT. AVA'S LIVING ROOM - EVENING

102

She's struggling and tired

NOAH
You okay?

AVA
Yeah

He gives her a look that says I know you're lying

AVA (CONT'D)
Fine, no.

NOAH
You want to lay down?

AVA
Yes

Noah helps her to the steps

NOAH
One step at a time... Take it slow

Noah supports her as they walk up the steps
They go into Ava's bedroom

103 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - EVENING

103

Noah helps Ava get to her bed

AVA
Thank you for being patient with me
(pause)
And for putting up with my attitude
all the time

Noah laughs slightly at that

He rolls his eyes

NOAH
You're welcome

AVA
(playfully)
Don't roll your eyes at me!

He shakes his head slightly

NOAH
Do you want me to stay here for a
bit until your mom gets home?

AVA
Please.

Noah sits on the far edge of her bed

AVA (CONT'D)
Why are you all the way over there?

NOAH
I don't know

AVA
Come here

Noah moves closer to her

Ava leans into his side

He puts his arm around her

She puts hers around him

Silence for a few seconds

AVA (CONT'D)
You gave up everything. You gave up
your entire life, Noah

NOAH
I know... I made that choice

AVA
But I didn't... I wouldn't have

NOAH
Don't say that.

AVA
You didn't have to do this

NOAH
But I did... and I'd do it a
million times again.

AVA
What if you regret it?
(pause)
Like a year from now?
(pause)
Or five?

NOAH
I won't.

AVA
You don't know that

NOAH
Yes I do.

AVA
How do you know?

NOAH
Because I know what it would be
like if I hadn't done it... And
that's worse.

There's a long silence before she responds

She looks up at him

AVA
I keep thinking this is all a dream
and I'm gonna wake up and it's not
real

NOAH
I promise it's real

AVA
You're different
(pause)
In a good way

NOAH
So are you

104 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

104

Noah walks into the bedroom and sees the paper on his bed
He goes over and picks it up
He stares at the words "I think I'm falling for U"
He puts the paper in his desk drawer
He sits down on his bed

105 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

105

Ava is alone, laying in her bed
She's clearly been crying, but not anymore
Claire knocks softly, then opens the door

CLAIRE
Hey. Dinner's ready

AVA
I'm not hungry

Claire comes in fully and sits on the edge of the bed

CLAIRE
Talk to me

AVA
I stood for 7 seconds on my own
last week

CLAIRE
I remember, that was amazing

AVA
I fell five times today, mom

Claire stays quiet

AVA (CONT'D)

Five. And I couldn't get back up either, Noah and Doctor Hannah had to help me.

(pause)

What if this... What if I'm stuck again? What if I can't stand for more than 7 seconds?

CLAIRE

Ava-

AVA

Please give me a real answer, not some bullshit reassurance that it's all going to get better.

Claire tenses slightly, but maintains her composure

CLAIRE

I don't know... But... I do know one thing

AVA

What?

CLAIRE

That you breathed a lot today without having to think about it.

(pause)

You didn't notice that did you?

Ava thinks and her breathing is manual now

CLAIRE (CONT'D)

3 months ago you noticed... You noticed every single breath didn't you?

AVA

I did.

Claire squeezes her hand slightly

CLAIRE

Come eat. Even if it's just a little

Ava holds onto Claire's hand to get up

Claire puts her arm around Ava

They walk together out of the room, slowly, shaky

106 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

106

Noah sits on his bed staring at the cork board which still has recruiting letters

He gets up and takes them all down

He stacks them neatly on his desk

He puts his helmet from his desk onto the floor

He reaches into a drawer on his desk and pulls out a printed photo of him and Ava in the hospital together as well as the note from earlier

He pins those on the cork board instead and then goes back to sit down

He stares at the photo and note, and his phone buzzes

He looks at the message

AVA (TEXT)
U awake?

NOAH (TEXT)
Yeah

AVA (TEXT)
Me too

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
Couldn't Sleep

NOAH (TEXT)
Same

AVA (TEXT)
Wyd?

NOAH (TEXT)
Nothing

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)
Just thinking

AVA (TEXT)
Abt football?

NOAH (TEXT)
A little

AVA (TEXT)
Thats ok u know

NOAH (TEXT)
Ik

AVA (TEXT)
You're allowed to miss it

NOAH (TEXT)
I know

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)
I don't regret it tho

AVA (TEXT)
I know you don't

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
That's what makes it more sad

He pauses and looks out the window to Ava's room

NOAH (TEXT)
I'm glad you're still here

AVA (TEXT)
Me too

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
Goodnight

NOAH (TEXT)
Goodnight Ava

He puts his phone on the charger

He looks out the window, then turns off his lamp

107 INT. CLAIRE'S CAR ON THE WAY TO PT - AFTERNOON

107

Claire is driving

Ava's in the passenger seat

CLAIRE
How far did you walk yesterday?

AVA
I didn't walk anywhere alone...
Doctor Hannah helped me walk down
the hall and back

CLAIRE
Did Noah go in with you?

AVA

Yeah

CLAIRE

Good... you're getting better, Ava

AVA

That's what he said too

(pause)

But it doesn't feel like I am... I
feel like I should already be able
to walk on my own

CLAIRE

It takes time

AVA

I know, I wish it didn't

CLAIRE

Me too. But it does

She pulls into the parking lot

Claire helps Ava into the building

108 INT. PHYSICAL THERAPY OFFICE - AFTERNOON

108

Ava sits down with Claire

Doctor Hannah comes into the room

DOCTOR HANNAH

Ava, come on back

Claire helps Ava stand and Doctor Hannah helps her walk back

Ava holds on to a rail in the hall

DOCTOR HANNAH (CONT'D)

I'm gonna let go of you now

(pause)

Hold on to the rail, and walk if
you can

AVA

Okay

Doctor Hannah lets go of Ava completely

Ava takes a few wobbly steps holding on to the rail, smiling

DOCTOR HANNAH
You're doing amazing! Keep going

Ava keeps walking slowly

DOCTOR HANNAH (CONT'D)
Okay, stop right there

Ava stops

AVA
Okay

DOCTOR HANNAH
Now try to let go of the rail...
I'll catch you if you fall

AVA
Okay

Ava lets go of the rail, and balances on her own for 7 seconds before falling

Doctor Hannah catches her and supports her

Ava grabs the rail again

DOCTOR HANNAH
Good job, that was a huge step up from yesterday

AVA
Thank you

109 INT. RESTAURANT - EVENING

109

Noah, Mason, Emma, Nick, and Jess are all sitting together

Emma is across from Noah

MASON
How's Ava doing? With recovery?

Noah's face lights up slightly with the mention of Ava

Emma notices that and stays quiet

NOAH
She's getting better, figuring out how to walk again

Mason also notices Noah's face and nudges him

MASON

You two should just make it
official already!

Everyone but Emma laughs genuinely

Emma forces a small laugh just a second later

EMMA

Yeah, what about you though. Have
you been able to run much since the
surgery?

Noah shrugs

NOAH

Some. Still getting back into it

Emma nods, paying more attention to his reactions than his
answer

EMMA

That's good, I saw you at the
field, you looked good.

Noah smiles slightly, but not fully

NOAH

I barely made it 20 yards.

EMMA

Still. I thought it was good

Noah doesn't respond yet, and Emma notices his detachment

EMMA (CONT'D)

Are you okay? You seem off

NOAH

Still just tired.

EMMA

Right.

(pause)

Well... just don't forget who was
here before you 'got tired'

Noah looks up at her. The others all just watch quietly

NOAH

Emma.

Emma smiles quickly, trying to recover from the unintentional
harshness

EMMA

I'm kidding. Relax, Noah.

Noah looks around

NOAH

Okay, I need to go

Noah stands up and starts walking away

EMMA

I'll see you at the game, Friday?

NOAH

Maybe

Noah walks out of the restaurant

MASON

Thanks, Emma.

EMMA

Hey! It's not my fault

NICK

Yeah, It kinda is. You said 'got tired'

EMMA

So?

JESS

You don't remember what he said before?

EMMA

No, what?

JESS

That Ava's dad left because he 'got tired'

Emma's eyes widen slightly with realization

110

EXT. OUTSIDE RESTAURANT - EVENING

110

Noah stands by his car and stares at his phone

A text comes in. He checks it quickly

AVA (TEXT)

Can u still take me to pt tmr?

NOAH (TEXT)

Yeah

AVA (TEXT)

Thx, you're the best

Noah smiles at that

He reacts to that last message with a heart

Noah gets in his car

111 INT. NOAH'S CAR ON THE WAY TO PT - AFTERNOON

111

Noah's driving, quietly

Ava's staring out the window

Noah parks and Ava keeps staring out the window

NOAH

You okay?

Tears well up in her eyes

AVA

No. I'm not. I can't do this, Noah.

NOAH

You can

Noah gets out and goes around to open her door

Ava leans toward him and he leans toward her

He puts his arms around her gently

She wraps her arms around him tight and holds on

NOAH (CONT'D)

I got you. It's okay

AVA

Don't let go

NOAH

I won't

They stay like that for a few seconds while she calms down

She wipes her tears and lets go of Noah

AVA
I think I'm ready

NOAH
Good, let's go

They walk into the physical therapy office, Noah supports her as they walk

112 EXT. STREET - EVENING

112

Noah and Ava are walking together

Silence for a few seconds

AVA
Why'd you do it?

He doesn't answer right away

He looks down, then back to her

NOAH
I couldn't walk away.

AVA
You had everything

NOAH
Maybe... But it wouldn't have felt
like everything
(pause)
It would've felt like nothing
without you.

Ava's expression softens a bit

AVA
Dumbass.

NOAH
(tiny laugh)
Yeah
(pause)
But I love you.

Ava doesn't respond right away

She looks at him, finally letting herself believe that

Her eyes well up slightly

AVA
 I... I love you too. But you're
 still a dumbass.
 (pause)
 My dumbass.

He holds her hand

AVA (CONT'D)
 You stayed

NOAH
 I told you I would.

She squeezes his hand tightly

NOAH (CONT'D)
 I was actually going to ask you
 something before...

AVA
 You mean before I almost died?

Noah lets out a small laugh

NOAH
 Yeah, before that
 (pause)
 I was going to ask... would you
 want to go out with me?

AVA
 We're literally out right now.

NOAH
 Yeah... I mean, like, officially.

AVA
 (smiles)
 Yes!

She squeezes his hand again

As they keep walking she pulls him down to kiss his cheek

He smiles as they keep walking

113 INT. NOAH'S KITCHEN - EVENING

113

David is standing by the sink drinking a glass of water

He glances out the window and sees Noah and Ava walking down
 the street holding hands, and laughing

He keeps looking for a while
 Julia walks up behind him and hugs him from behind
 Then she follows his gaze out the window

JULIA
 When's the last time you saw him
 this happy?

David takes a second to think before responding

DAVID
 Not in a long time

114 EXT. TRACK - EARLY MORNING

114

Noah's alone stretching
 Coach Reynolds approaches

COACH REYNOLDS
 You cleared?

NOAH
 Yeah.

COACH REYNOLDS
 You look lighter.

NOAH
 I am

COACH REYNOLDS
 You don't have to prove anything.

NOAH
 I'm not.

Noah starts jogging
 Breathing heavily
 He slows but doesn't stop
 When he finally does stop, he checks his old time on his
 phone, then checks his new time
 He deletes the old time and locks his phone

NOAH (CONT'D)
 I'm done.

115 EXT. BLEACHERS - MORNING

115

Noah's sitting on the bleachers breathing heavily

David walks up to the bleachers

NOAH

Dad?

(pause)

Why are you here?

DAVID

Wanted to come see how you did...

(pause)

How'd it feel?

NOAH

Slow... Really slow

DAVID

Yeah

David sits on the step next to Noah

DAVID (CONT'D)

After my injury, I used to dream
every night that I was still
playing.

(pause)

And every time, I'd wake up feeling
like I lost everything

NOAH

Do you still?

DAVID

No... That all stopped when you got
into football

Noah doesn't respond yet

DAVID (CONT'D)

I was wrong at the hospital, before
the surgery

NOAH

Dad-

David cuts him off

DAVID

I was wrong, son.

(pause)

(MORE)

DAVID (CONT'D)
 What you did... That took more guts
 than anything I've ever done.

Noah still stays quiet

David stands up and puts his hand on Noah's shoulder

DAVID (CONT'D)
 Catch your breath and go to your
 classes. I'm heading home

NOAH
 Okay, bye Dad

David walks away, and waves back at Noah once

116 INT. NOAH'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

116

Noah's laying in bed scrolling through his phone

He sees a post from a recruiting account with his face

The caption reads "Keep an eye on this one 🧐 "

He clicks on the account and scrolls through posts of other
 kids his age who still have these opportunities

His eyes drift to his desk where his old recruiting letters
 are stacked

He looks up slightly to the cork board and sees the picture
 of him and Ava

He looks back to his phone and unfollows the account and
 locks his phone

He closes his eyes

NOAH
 (to himself)
 It's fine... I'm fine.

He stays quiet for a few seconds

NOAH (CONT'D)
 Thank you, God. Thank you so much
 for keeping her safe.

117 INT. AVA'S BATHROOM - MORNING

117

Ava standing in front of her mirror alone

Her hand lifts to her chest
She traces the surgical scar through her shirt
She takes a deep breath

118 EXT. BLEACHERS - AFTERNOON

118

Noah is on the bleachers
Takes a deep breath
Mason sits beside Noah on the bleachers
Emma is quietly watching from a distance

MASON

Noah

NOAH

Yeah?

MASON

You regret it?

NOAH

No

MASON

You're not playing anymore, man.
That's gotta be tough

NOAH

It is, but it's worth it

MASON

Ava must be a really special girl

NOAH

She is

MASON

So... are you two like... A thing
yet?

NOAH

Yeah, I asked her out last night

Emma's face drops, but she stays quiet and walks away

MASON

Congratulations, man! You two should come to the football game tomorrow. Should be a good one

NOAH

I'll ask her

119 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - AFTERNOON

119

Ava's laying in bed on her phone

CLAIRE (O.S.)

Ava! Come on downstairs! Lunch is ready!

AVA

Okay! Coming!

Ava gets up and walks to her bedroom door to go downstairs

120 INT. AVA'S KITCHEN - AFTERNOON

120

Claire brings Ava a peanut butter and jelly and chips

CLAIRE

Here you go

AVA

Thanks

Ava starts eating the sandwich and chips

CLAIRE

Are you hanging out with Noah today?

AVA

No he's staying late at school. Said he wants to try to jog a little bit or something. His coach is timing him.

CLAIRE

You better tell him not to push too hard

AVA

I will, but he knows when to stop

CLAIRE
Okay... So how are you feeling
today?

AVA
Much better than before

CLAIRE
Good, you better be nice to that
boy. You owe him.

AVA
I know

121 INT. MORGANTOWN HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - AFTERNOON

121

Noah is walking slowly through the hall

Emma sees him and walks over

EMMA
Noah

NOAH
Oh, hi Emma. What's up?

EMMA
That was really nice of you. That
girl is lucky to have you

NOAH
Thanks

EMMA
I overheard you and Mason talking
earlier... Are you and Ava...
together?

NOAH
Yeah, we are.

Emma's face drops slightly for a second before she masks her
jealousy with a smile

EMMA
Oh... That's cool. Well I gotta
head to class, Bye.

NOAH
Bye

Emma walks to her class

Noah walks toward his and in the hall he passes Cole

Noah nods

Cole nods back

They both keep walking

122

INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - EVENING

122

Ava's sitting on the edge of her bed, on through her phone

She opens the messages app and goes to Noah's contact

AVA (TEXT)

Don't push urself too hard tn

NOAH (TEXT)

Did your mom tell u to say that?

AVA (TEXT)

Maybe...

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)

She also said I have to be nice to
u cuz I owe u 🙄

NOAH (TEXT)

U don't owe me anything, Ava

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Btw there's a football game tmr
night. Want to go?

AVA (TEXT)

Do you want to?

NOAH (TEXT)

If u go

AVA (TEXT)

Ok then let's go

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)

Don't push it tn.

NOAH (TEXT)

I won't, ily

AVA (TEXT)

Say it

NOAH (TEXT)
Say what?

AVA (TEXT)
You know what

NOAH (TEXT)
I LOVE YOU

AVA (TEXT)
Much better, ily too

NOAH (TEXT)
Ur so mean

AVA (TEXT)


123 EXT. TRACK - EVENING

123

Noah tries to run again
Coach Reynolds times him
He finishes, really slowly

COACH REYNOLDS
Different Body

Noah nods

COACH REYNOLDS (CONT'D)
Different race now

NOAH
Yeah

COACH REYNOLDS
You know you can't play football
anymore, right?

NOAH
I know

COACH REYNOLDS
But that doesn't mean you can't be
around the sport. There's plenty of
other options that would keep you
involved with football.

NOAH
Like what?

COACH REYNOLDS
Sports Medicine, Coaching the
younger receivers, and there's
other options too.

Noah nods slightly, considering it

124 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - MORNING

124

Ava's asleep, the clock reads "6:59AM"

It flips to "7:00AM" and the alarm goes off

Ava wakes up and silences it

She groans and rolls over covering her face with a pillow

AVA
(muffled by the pillow)
Stupid-ass alarm

Her phone buzzes

She immediately sits up

She rubs her eyes and checks her phone

NOAH (TEXT)
Game starts at 6

NOAH (TEXT) (CONT'D)
U want to leave around 5?

AVA (TEXT)
Loved "U want to leave around 5?"

AVA (TEXT) (CONT'D)
See u then

125 EXT. NOAH'S DRIVEWAY - EVENING

125

Ava walks from her front door to Noah's driveway

Noah walks out of his house

NOAH
Ready?

AVA
Yeah, I've never been to a football
game in person before

NOAH
You're gonna love it

Noah opens the passenger door and Ava gets in
Noah goes to the driver's seat and starts driving

126 INT. NOAH'S CAR ON THE WAY TO SCHOOL - EVENING 126
Ava's staring out the window
Noah's driving with his left hand
Noah reaches to hold Ava's hand
She gives his hand a squeeze
They pull into the parking lot

127 EXT. FOOTBALL FIELD - EVENING 127
Noah leads Ava to their seats in the bleachers
Travis and Kenzie are seated nearby

AVA
Wow, this is huge

NOAH
Yeah

They sit together and watch the teams warming up
Noah's phone buzzes
He check it and finds a message

RECRUITER (TEXT)
Hey, Noah. Please let us know if
you're planning on joining our
football program. We'd love to have
you here! Reply STOP at any time to
stop getting these texts.

Noah types back

NOAH (TEXT)
STOP

He deletes the message thread and locks his phone
He turns his attention back to the field

Ava leans her head on his shoulder and closes her eyes

Travis is laughing about something Kenzie said, then he notices Noah and Ava

He glances over at them, Kenzie follows his glance

Travis looks back away from Noah and Ava

Kenzie looks up to Travis

KENZIE
(whispering)
She made it

Travis doesn't respond, he takes a sip of his drink and looks to the field

The ANNOUNCER starts the pre-game announcements

ANNOUNCER
Please stand for our National
Anthem

Everyone stands up

Noah helps Ava stand slowly

The Star Spangled Banner starts playing

The players line the sidelines

Everyone stays quiet for the song

After it's over everyone claps and then sits down

NOAH
You okay?

AVA
Yeah, I'm better than okay

Noah smiles and they turn to the field where the players are lined up for kickoff.

The kicker sets up the tee

The referee raises his hand

Blows the whistle

The kicker runs up and kicks the ball to start the game

128 INT. AVA'S ROOM - NIGHT

128

She stands by her window, without any help

Noah's in his room doing the same

They wave

Ava walks to her bed and gets her phone to call Noah

NOAH (V.O.)

Hey

AVA

Hi

NOAH (V.O.)

You feeling okay?

AVA

Yeah, I feel amazing compared to
before

NOAH (V.O.)

Good, what are you doing tomorrow?

AVA

Nothing yet... why?

NOAH (V.O.)

Do you want to go on a walk?

AVA

Yes, please. I need it

NOAH (V.O.)

Me too

(pause)

And maybe tomorrow night I can keep
my promise from before?

AVA

Which promise?

NOAH (V.O.)

The one about watching Harry Potter
outside together

AVA

You still want to do that?

NOAH (V.O.)

Yeah, of course I do

(pause)

(MORE)

NOAH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 Plus, it means I get to spend more
 time with you

AVA
 (teasingly)
 Of course... you can't just do it
 cause you actually want to watch it

Noah laughs slightly

NOAH (V.O.)
 You're impossible

AVA
 I know.

She looks through the window

Noah rolls his eyes playfully

NOAH (V.O.)
 When do you want to go?

AVA
 Eight?

NOAH (V.O.)
 Eight. I'll be ready

AVA
 Good, I love you

NOAH (V.O.)
 I love you too. Goodnight

AVA
 Goodnight, Noah

She hangs up

Flops down on her bed smiling

She reaches over to her nightstand

Turns off the lamp

129 EXT. STREET - MORNING

129

Ava walks out of her front door without help

She goes to Noah's front door

She knocks on the door

Noah answers it

NOAH
Ava, How are you feeling?

AVA
Better than I have in years

NOAH
Good

AVA
Ready to go on our walk?

NOAH
Yeah, let's go

He comes outside

They start walking side by side

Noah reaches for Ava's hand

She intertwines their fingers

Turns her head to look up at him

She smiles

They keep walking

AVA
Still the most boring street in
America

NOAH
It also still has potential

130 EXT. AVA'S BACKYARD - EVENING

130

The sun is starting to set

Noah and Ava are hanging a sheet between two trees

AVA
Noah?

NOAH
Yeah?

AVA
What if this all goes away?

NOAH
Then we'll deal with it, together.

AVA
You're not scared?

NOAH
Of course I'm scared
(pause)
But I'd rather have this... us...
and risk losing it, than never have
it at all.

Ava sitting cross-legged on a blanket on the grass

Noah beside her

Laptop buffering the movie plugged into the projector

After a couple seconds the opening credits of Harry Potter
and the Sorcerer's Stone begin

She breathes evenly

Ava looks at Noah

AVA
You've really never seen this?

NOAH
I've seen clips

AVA
That doesn't count

She nudges him

He nudges back

On the projector the movie is playing

Noah glances at her instead of the screen

She notices and turns her head toward him

AVA (CONT'D)
Watch the movie

NOAH
I am

She breathes again as they scoot closer

They make eye contact and hold it

Ava's breathing changes slightly
 Noah notices and looks down, then back to her eyes
 Ava leans closer and closes her eyes as she Kisses Noah
 Noah's eyes widen for a half second before fluttering shut
 Noah's hand moves to cup Ava's cheek
 They kiss for a few seconds before she pulls back slightly
 They lean their foreheads against each other, smiling
 Ava giggles softly, turning to lay her head on his shoulder
 He turns back to the screen and wraps his arm around her
 She leaves her head on his shoulder while watching the movie
 Claire is in the kitchen watching them through the window
 She smiles and closes the blinds

CUT TO:

END CREDITS

CUT TO:

131 BLACK SCREEN

131

Ava and Noah's breathing together

AVA
 Still there?

NOAH
 Obviously.